

SCORE
B O A R D Specifications

The Office Facts				
Details	602Pro PC Suite 2000b	Lotus SmartSuite Millenium 9.6	Microsoft Office XP (Standard)	StarOffice 5.2
Contact Address	www.software602.com	Lotus Development Industrial Corporation, Phone: 2322024, Fax : 2322026 E-mail: india@lotus.com	Microsoft (India), Phone: 011-6294600, E-mail: undarb@microsoft.com, Web site: www.microsoft.com	www.staroffice.com
Price	Free	Rs 5,500	Rs 20,500	Free
Components	602Text, 602Tab, 602Photo	Word Pro, 1-2-3, Freelance Graphics, Lotus Approach, Lotus Organizer	Word 2002, Excel 2002, PowerPoint 2002, Outlook 2002	StarOffice Writer, StarOffice Calc, StarOffice Impress, StarOffice Draw, StarOffice Mail, Schedule
Installation Size (Typical)	49 MB	279 MB	219 MB	170 MB
Install customisation	Fully customisable	Fully customisable	Fully customisable	Have to install StarWriter
Help	Context-sensitive in 602Text only	Ask the expert for guidance	Non context-sensitive, but uses Smart Tags	Context-sensitive
Word Processor	602Text	Word Pro	Word 2002	StarOffice Writer
Grammar Check	No	Yes	Yes	No
Different portrait and landscape layouts	No	Yes	Yes	No
Tables	Basic features	Provides cell-wrapping options in table	Can draw table, add diagnoi lines	Basic features
Spreadsheet	602Tab	1-2-3	Excel 2002	StarOffice Calc
Indian currency support	No	Support for INR	Support for INR	No
Charts	Basic 2D and 3D	2D and 3D	2D and 3D	Advanced lighting and texture features
Error checking	No	Tracing	Tracing Dependents and Precedents	Detective option
Presentation	Not present	Freelance Graphics	PowerPoint 2002	StarOffice Impress
Wizards and templates	NA	Provision of content templates	Quite extensive templates	Entirely wizard driven
Transition and Effects	NA	Customisable sequencing of objects	Task Pane provides number of transitions and animation effects	Normal transition and effects
Slide Show	NA	Rehearse Timings, add pointers	Narration, Add Buttons, Live Broadcast	Edit presentations live
Verdict	B-	A-	A	B+

CONCLUSION

What do you want in an office suite? That's the most important question that, you, as a user have to answer. With each succeeding version, developers are packing in more and more features in the suite and it is likely that you might not even use half of these features. **Microsoft Office XP** definitely scores over the other contenders in the sheer number of features that are offered. With the effective use of the Task Pane, there is the additional dimension of simplicity too. But remember that these features come at a price. The standard version of Office XP costs Rs 20,500 and that's nearly four times the price of Lotus SmartSuite Millennium Edition. And if



Microsoft Office XP:
Need we add more?

you measure this against 602Pro and StarOffice that are free, you end up with quite an uneven comparison in terms of

price. For that matter, even the Professional and Premium Editions of Microsoft Office 2000 are priced lesser than Office XP (ranging from Rs 15,000 to Rs 19,000), so you can also get Access 2000, FrontPage, Publisher and other development tools for that price. The only real lure of Office XP over its earlier versions would be in areas of collaborative work when the document passes among many reviewers or when you are trying to integrate the Web and your office applications. For normal home use that just involves simple documentation, basic calculations and presentations, a free suite such as StarOffice is more sensible and doesn't have major compatibility issues. **A**